

Norton Ghost 2003

Your friendly neighbourhood ghost

Norton Ghost 2003 facilitates backup, restoration and cloning data for disaster recovery. With the new release, even NTFS partitions in Windows NT environment can be backed up and restored. It also supports backing up, restoring and cloning EXT3 file systems in Linux.

To perform all these tasks, Norton needs to copy all the required files in the virtual partition it creates. This is a space constraint on the Master Boot Record (MBR), which is the location of the partition.

The disaster recovery facility lets you prepare a bootable disk, which you can use to start the computer.

Unlike the previous version where you had to back up the entire drive, Norton Ghost 2003 lets you back up just the partitions.

Another important addition is the support for external USB drives. Norton Ghost also

provides a unique feature of letting you explore the contents of an image file as if it were a folder on a local drive. You can even check the integrity of the image file as soon as it is backed up, before proceeding to restore.

What the software lacks is an intuitive interface and a scheduler for taking backups. Its interface is limited to the wizards for setting up new tasks; after that it reverts to a DOS-based system, effectively bringing the system to a standstill as you cannot multitask.

Though a good product, it is always better to buy the complete system suite rather than just an individual product. Besides, for first time users, there are other easier-to-use software available.

SPECIFICATIONS

486 processor, VGA monitor, 16 MB RAM, Windows 98/2000/Me/XP/NT4 SP6a, Internet Explorer 5

Norton Ghost 2003		B
Performance	►►►►►	
Ease of use	►►►►►	
Value for money	►►►►►	
Features	►►►►►	
OVERALL	►►►►►	

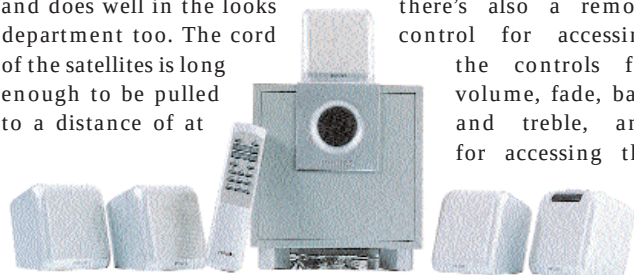
Price: Rs 2,633
Contact: Symantec
Phone: 022-26570658
E-mail: adeshpande@symantec.com
Web site: www.symantec.com

Philips A5.600

The power of six

The Philips A5.600 5.1-channel speaker offers good quality surround sound and does well in the looks department too. The cord of the satellites is long enough to be pulled to a distance of at

least 15 feet from the PC. The set has digital volume control on the centre speaker and there's also a remote control for accessing the controls for volume, fade, bass and treble, and for accessing the



other features.

The speakers were very responsive in the low, mid and high frequencies—something that Indian music lovers will appreciate. It gave good results when VOB files were played using PowerDVD—the sound effects were quite thrilling when playing games such as *Quake III Arena* and *Need for Speed: Porsche 2000*. However, the real power of these speakers is evident while playing rock or heavy-metal music.

Price: Rs 7,500
Contact: Philips Sound Solutions
Phone: 020-7124196
Fax: 020-7123175
E-mail: pss.sales.marketing@philips.com
Web site: www.philips.com/sound

The only thing missing from this speaker set are the stands for the satellites. The A5.600 is expensive at Rs 7,500, but you wouldn't mind the price if crystal clear, booming sound is what you crave.

SPECIFICATIONS

50 watts RMS power output for subwoofer, 10 watts RMS for the satellites, 40 Hz-20 KHz frequency response, five satellite, one subwoofer, unified 5-channel chord, audio cable, remote with batteries, manual

Philips A5.600		B+
Performance	►►►►►	
Build quality	►►►►►	
Value for money	►►►►►	
Features	►►►►►	
OVERALL	►►►►►	

WinTally-Acc

Tally ho!

WinTally-Acc is an easy-to-install, versatile accounting system. It provides a standard graphical Windows interface and anyone with basic knowledge of Windows can start working with the software. The tree view interface makes it easy to locate a report from among the hundreds of files. Also, the use of graphical representation and icons makes the interface very interactive.

The software has a lot of features that can be enabled or disabled depending on your requirements. It has special features such as the ability to lock the year field when finalising the accounts for a particular year. The Repair Company command creates an auto-

matic backup on a user-specified day and time. You can also choose to display any statement as per the required data.

With the capability to print, e-mail, save and publish any displayed screen, this is a very handy utility.

Its one glaring flaw is that the data is not very safe as the database used is MS Access, which can be edited very easily. However, the Auditing command records all actions, helping you keep a check on the editing changes done by other users.

Overall, this is a feature-packed, easy-to-use software, but the price is a bit on the higher side.

SPECIFICATIONS

Pentium 233 MHz processor, 64 MB RAM, high colour settings, 20 MB hard disk space

Price: Rs 7,500 (single user); Rs 11,500 (10 users)
Contact: Lify Pvt Ltd
Phone: (0) 98220 16457
Fax: 022-2237 5845
E-mail: lifycom@lify.com
Web site: www.lify.com

WinTally-Acc		B
Performance	►►►►►	
Ease of use	►►►►►	
Value for money	►►►►►	
Features	►►►►►	
OVERALL	►►►►►	